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ISSUE 06: YOU ARE HERE. OUT NOW.

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Big Tech's Fight for Our Attention Is Making Us Lonely: Why Embracing Solitude Could Be the Solution

George Harry James

When did streaming on the Underground become a thing? These days every carriage will have at least a few commuters transfixed by *Friends* or *Mad Men* or *Love is Blind*, thanks to the miracle of offline playback and Transport for London's gradual 4G rollout. For all its grime and chaos, there was something endearing about the tube's holdout against the ultra-connectivity of the surface world, which oozes into every space we inhabit and promises something better. At work, in the gym, in the bathroom, and now while travelling 85 feet deep into the earth, we fulfil our modern function to consume content and produce data.

Sleep, the CEO of Netflix once joked, is their toughest competition.

Except it's not a joke. Those who own the platforms that we tap, swipe, and stare at are deadly serious about capturing our attention, as frequently and for as long as possible.

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